

English Literature: Shakespeare

Shakespeare's tragedies explore ambition (Macbeth), jealousy (Othello), and indecision (Hamlet). His sonnets follow the ABAB CDCD EFEF GG rhyme scheme. Close reading analyzes diction, imagery, syntax, and tone. The tragic hero has a fatal flaw (hamartia) leading to downfall. Dramatic irony occurs when the audience knows something characters do not. Soliloquies reveal inner thoughts directly to the audience.